
: (In a soft tone) How little! How naked, and – how bold!


: The baby was pushing his way between the cubs to get close to the warm hide.


: So this is a man's cub. Now, was there a wolf that could boast of a Man's cub among her children?


: I have heard now and again of such a thing, but never in our Pack or in my time. But see, he looks up and is not afraid.


: The moonlight was blocked out of the mouth of the cave, for Shere Khan's great square head and shoulders were thrust into the entrance. Tabaqui behind him, was squeaking.


: My Lord, my Lord, it went in here!


: Shere Khan does us great honour, (angrily) what does he need?


: My quarry. A Man's cub went this way. Its parents have run off. Give it to me.


: Shere Khan had jumped at a woodcutter's campfire, as Father Wolf had said, and was furious from the pain of his burned feet. But Father Wolf knew that the mouth of the cave was too narrow for a tiger to come in by. Even where he was, Shere Khan's shoulders and forepaws were cramped for want of room as a Man's cub would be if he tried to fight in a barrel.


: The Wolves are a free people. They take orders from the Head of the Pack, and not from any striped cattle-killer. The Man's cub is ours – to hunt if we choose.


: What talk is this of choosing? It is I, Shere Khan, who speaks!


: The tiger's roar filled the cave with thunder. Mother Wolf shook herself clear of the cubs and sprang forward, her eyes, like two green moons in the darkness, facing the blazing eyes of Shere Khan.


: And it is I, Raksha, 'The Demon', who answers. The Man's cub is mine. He shall live to run with the Pack and to hunt with the Pack; and in the end, he shall hunt you!


: Father Wolf looked on amazed. He had almost forgotten the days when he won Mother Wolf in a fair fight from five other wolves, when she ran in the Pack and was not called 'The Demon' for compliment's sake. Shere Khan might have faced Father Wolf, but he could not stand up against Mother Wolf, for he knew that where he was she had all the advantage of the ground, and would fight to the death. So backed out of the cave mouth growling, and when he was clear he shouted.


: Each dog barks in his own yard! We will see what the Pack will say to this fostering of man-cubs. The man-cub is mine and will come to me in the end!

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